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Body as symbol? – The making of the body of the pharaoh from an *anthropo-poietical* perspective

Abstract: *The authors of the paper attempt to scrutinise, with reference to contextual arguments, the linguistic image of the body of the pharaoh in Old Kingdom ancient Egyptian religious texts, the so-called* Pyramid Texts. *The analysis is done from two perspectives, that of an Egyptologist and the other of a cultural anthropologist. We believe the theory of* anthropo-poiesis *of Francesco Remotti may be of use while interpreting the complexity of the ancient Egyptian beliefs concerning the vital essence that the God share with the pharaoh. It may help to understand the way the Egyptians expressed their religious concepts regarding their ruler. However, we have noted some meaningful differences between ancient Egyptian religious beliefs and other cultures, discrepant patterns: if the manipulation of the human essence has always been studied in anthropology with implication of blood, dolour and painful body modification, in the Egyptian context we discover a milder and more poetic solution of transmission.*

Keywords: ancient Egyptian *Pyramid Texts*, body, *anthropo-poiesis*, pharaoh

Introduction

The linguistic concept of the body of the Egyptian pharaoh seems to be a multi-faceted, well-thought idea. Joanna Popielska-Grzybowska has studied the *topos of completeness*[1] in the *Pyramid Texts* and this pursuit allows for a reconstruction of the linguistic image of the pharaoh, his role and predestined place in the world of the living and in the Hereafter. Federica Manfredi has worked on the symbolic construction that various cultures operate on the body[2] in order to elaborate their vision of humanity. Rarely is the human being perceived as complete from his/her birth: most cultures accept manipulations, both symbolically and physically, in order to shape a specific and complete form of their mankind. This is the approach of the *anthropo-poiesis* theory of Francesco Remotti[3] and we believe that it may be used to interpret the complexity of ancient Egyptian beliefs concerning the vital essence (*ka*) that god shares with the pharaoh. It may help to understand the way the Egyptians expressed their religious concepts regarding their ruler. The *anthropo-poiesis* perspective

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1 J. Popielska-Grzybowska, *"O Osiris Nemtiemzaf Merenre, you are the essence of all the gods". The Pyramid Texts as a Source of Topoi in the Coffin Texts*, forthcoming (hereinafter referred to as: *O Osiris Nemtiemzaf Merenre*).

2 F. Manfredi, No names, no memorials. The migrants' invisible deaths, [in:] J. Popielska-Grzybowska, J. Iwaszczuk (eds), *Studies on Disasters, Catastrophes and the Ends of the World in Sources*, Acta Archaeologica Pultuskiensia IV, Pultusk 2013, pp. 201-204; Eadem, Addomesticare la morte: un'interpretazione antropologica del tatuaggio, [in:] *International conference Seeing beyond in facing death (Vedere Oltre. La spiritualità dinnanzi al morire: dal corpo malato alla salvezza), 25-28th September*, Padua (Italy), p. 70; Eadem, Body symbols: the use of body in an anthropological perspective, see above, pp. 183-188.

3 F. Remotti, Tesi per una prospettiva antropo-poietica, [in:] S. Allovio, A. Favole, *Le fucine rituali. Temi di antropo-poiesi*, Turin 1996, pp. 9-25; Idem (ed.), Le antropologie degli altri. Saggi di etno-antropologia, Turin 1997; Idem, Thèses pour une perspective anthropopoietique, [in:] C. Calame, M. Kilani (eds), *La fabrication de l'humaindans les cultures et en anthropologie*, Lousanne 1999, pp. 15-31; Idem (ed.), *Forme di umanità*, Milan 2002.

can also highlight the process of constituting divinity, as well as humanity in ancient Egyptian culture. However, we have noted some meaningful differences between ancient Egyptian religious beliefs and other cultures, discrepant patterns: if manipulation of the human essence has often been studied in anthropology, with implications for blood, dolour and painful body interventions, in the Egyptian context we discover a milder and more poetic solution of transmission.

We decided to work together to reach a perspective that joins two different ways of analysing the scholarly facts, two varying scholarly approaches. For the first time, we will apply *anthropo-poiesis* theory in Egyptology, proposing an interdisciplinary innovative approach.

Moreover, we study the *Pyramid Texts* – the world's oldest religious texts – to be able to analyse the topic at its source.

Methods

The authors use the linguistic worldview methods elaborated by Jerzy Bartmiński, and his collaborators and colleagues, and the theory of Francesco Remotti called *anthropo-poiesis*, as it has already been mentioned above.

The linguistic worldview[4] studies culture in language and culture through language. *Anthropo-poiesis* is a theoretical approach formed on the ruminations of an Italian scholar based in Turin, who observed that the "making of the human being" is largely used in the social sciences: ethnographic data shows that humanity is not "natural", it is not given or guaranteed once and for all. It has to be made, created, shaped continuously, generation after generation. The second main aspect of the theory refers to biological incompleteness[5] which is inextricably linked to human existence, to the human being him/herself. When we are born we are not able to survive alone in the world and this is one of the reasons we depend on culture and its learning, which come to us thanks to our parents' and counterparts' care and teachings, also called primary "inculturation".[6] But there is another piece of evidence of our incompleteness, located in our own body and brain. As many neurobiologists, such as Jean-Pierre Changeux[7] and Gerald M. Edelman,[8] have recently confirmed, the human brain continues to develop after birth. Their researches show that newborns' brains are rich in neural connections, much more so than those of adults, and that they correspond with the extraordinary potential of ability. However, this power is destined to be a sacrifice: in order to develop specific abilities, the brain activates only some neuronal connections, allowing others to die. It would be wonderful to be able to do everything for our brains to activate all their potential, but this is unreal, impossible. Therefore, in order to learn specific skills, such as the pronunciation of the phoneme of the Italian language as a mother-tongue, the

4 W. von Humboldt, *On Language: on the Diversity of Human Language Construction and its Influence on the Mental Development of the Human Species*, trans. Peter Heath, ed. M. Losonsky, Cambridge 1999 (1836); E. Sapir, *Selected Writings in Language, Culture and Personality*, ed. D. Mandelbaum, Berkeley 1949; B.L. Whorf, *Language, Thought and Reality. Selected Writings of Benjamin Lee Whorf*, ed. J.B. Caroll, Boston 1956; J. Bartmiński, *Językowe podstawy obrazu świata*, Lublin 2009 and Idem, *Aspects of Cognitive Ethnolinguistics*, London 2009 and see also: J.L. Weisgerber, *Die vier Stufen in der Erforschung der Sprachen*, Cologne 1963; A. Pajdzińska, R. Tokarski, Językowy obraz świata – konwencja i kreacja, *Pamiętnik Literacki* 4 (1996), pp. 143-158; R. Tokarski, Językowy obraz świata a niektóre założenia kognitywizmu, *Etnolingwistyka* 9/10 (1999), pp. 7-24.

5 C. Geertz, The transition to Humanity, [in:] S. Tax (ed.), *Horizons of Anthropology*, London 1965, pp. 37-48; G.J. Herder, *Idee per la filosofia della storia dell'umanità*, Bologna 1971; A. Gehlen, *L'uomo. La sua natura e il suo posto nel mondo*, Milan 1990.

6 J. Ries, L.E. Sullivan, *Metamorfosi del sacro. Acculturazione, inculturazione, sincretismo, fondamentalismo*, Milan 2009; É. Durkheim, *Education at sociologie*, Paris 1922.

7 J.P. Changeux, *L'homme neuronal*, Paris 1983.

8 G.M. Edelman, *Bright air, brilliant fire. On the matter of mind*, New York 1992.

human being irreparably loses his/her ability to do something else, speaking Chinese as a native language for example, and the human brain starts to specialise in a specific form of humanity with a peculiar ability. In the case of the language, its specificity will also be referred to the tongue's movements and characteristics of the vocal apparatus.

Thanks to the theory of the incompleteness of "human biology," we can extend our considerations to all of mankind, outdoing the idea of Descartes for whom culture was a layer on the top of biology.[9] We can consider culture as an element that completes the human being, even within an anatomical perspective: it modifies our body not only with piercings and tattoos, circumcisions or haircuts, but it also moulds our brains at the neuronal level.

Underlining the importance of culture in the constitution of women and men means to accept that culture shapes and forms its own members. Consequently, we come to the theory of the *anthropo-poiesis* the term derived from the Greek verb *poièin* [to make, to create] and the Greek noun ánthropos [human being].

Furthermore, this approach shows that biological incompleteness is partially corrected by culture's contribution: we have the illusion of completeness but we do not have final solutions. In fact there is a plurality of human models on our planet (each one understood to be the most *natural* and/or true) and humanity, once again, is not completed once and for all. Of course the *anthropo-poiesis* approach does not offer a final answer to humanity's origin but it does highlight the making of the process and helps explain the plurality of models elaborated by various cultures.

Cultures are often invoked to solve problems concerning the availability of humanity models. Remotti considers four categories as the main sources. Our idea of the human being can be inspired by the animal kingdom (zoology), by ancestors (progonology), by other cultures (xenology) or by the divine world (theology). Considering overlapping categories as well, all sources valorise what is outside the person and they demonstrate that we do not have enough in and of ourselves to constitute 'ourselves.' Cultures are based on the support of our ancestors, our neighbours (or maybe our enemies), animals, as well as the help of our gods to shape a specific form of humanity.

This last aspect is particularly relevant to the *Pyramid Texts*, where we can observe that life essence (*ka*) is shared between the pharaoh and god. A reason for the divine nature of the pharaoh, a unique example between humans and god, could be applied to *anthropo-poiesis* theory not only to analyse the "creation" of humanity in ancient Egyptian beliefs but also to investigate the process of making divinity.

The discussed theory has been developed mostly in Italy and France, but not much has been published worldwide; hence there is, we believe, one more reason to popularise this refreshing and helpful method.

Following the *Pyramid Texts*' examples

The body of the King in the *Pyramid Texts* needs to be revivified. As mentioned before, we find the idea of making and producing the body very common in ethnography. To reach this aim the pharaoh must have all body parts in their rightful places, in accordance with biological order and according to a specific *anthropo-poietical* project, which is described as 'very carnal.'

Hence the monarch had to act – had to move, raise himself, run, jump. He had to find all his body members and put them together, and especially to put his head on:

§ 654a *jhj jhj ṯz ṯw NN pw*
§ 654b *šzp n.k tpj.k jnḳ n.k ḳsw.k*
§ 654c *sꜣḳ n.k ꜥwt.k*

[9] R. Descartes, *Discours de la méthode*, Leiden 1637.

§ 654d *wḫ3 n.k t3 jr jf.k*
§ 655a *šzp n.k t.k j.ḫm ḫsḏ ḥnḳt.k j.ḫmt ꜥm3*
§ 655b *ꜥḥꜥ.k jr ꜥ3w ḫsf rḫwt*
(...)
§ 657e *tz tw NN pw nj mjjt.k / mt.k*

Oho, oho! Raise yourself, o King, receive your head, collect your bones, gather your (body) members together, throw off earth from your body, receive your bread which does not grow mouldy and your beer which does not grow sour, and stand at the door which restrains the (*common*) *people.*
(...)
Rise yourself, o King, for you have not died! /*PT* spell 373 § 654a-655b, § 657e, (T 204)/

Conversely, the members of the body of the pharaoh could have been put together by someone else, for instance by his son. He is the one who has the *anthropo-poietical* power and responsibility for constituting the pharaoh.

§ 1675a *tz tw jt.j tz n.k tpj.k s3ḳ n.k ꜥwt.k*
§ 1675b *wtz tw m rdwj.k sšm* [*tw jb.k*]
§ *1676a [*zḫz*] *jnw.k nt3j* [*ḥwtw.k*
§ *1676b *j smr.k nfr n ḥrw 3ḫt*]
§ *1676c *j jnpw ḫsf jm.k*
§ *1676d *rḏ.n n.k ḥtp ꜥ.f*
§*1676e *nḥnj ntrw j.ḥꜥꜥ šmsw-ḥrw*
§*1677a *j 3ḫj m 3ḫj.f jn psḏtj*
§*1677b *ḏ3.n.f šj nm.n.f d3t*
§ *1677c [*nj ḏ3 rd.f*] *nj srḥ.f ḫr sḫm pn ḏdd* [*rꜥ nb*
§ 1678a *j.n jt.j ḥḳ3.f nwwt sšm.f grgwt*]
§ 1678b *wḏ.f mdw n jmw nw*
§ *1679a *ḥms r.k r sm3 pw j3b*
§ *1679b *j.ḏḥ.k jtm sḳbb.k nḏm*
§ *1679c *šms.k rꜥ m w3ḏ.f*
§ *1679d *pr.k ḥnꜥ.f m* [\\\\\\\\\\\
§ *1679e *|||||||||||.k m ꜥnḫ m jmnt*
§ *1679f *mm šmsw rꜥ jsꜥw ḥrt n ꜥnḏ*]

Raise yourself, my father! Your head has been tied on for you, your limbs have been collected for you. Your feet will bear you, and [*your heart*] *will lead* [*you*].
Your envoys [*have run, your heralds have*] *hastened,* [*and the good report of you has come to Horus of the Akhet*]. *Anubis has come to meet you, the contented one has given you his arm.*
The gods will rejoice, the followers of Horus will become aroused. 'An akh *has come in his* akh*,' says the Dual Ennead, 'having crossed the lake and traversed the Duat.* [*His foot cannot be crossed] and he [cannot] be denounced before this Controlling Power who endures* [*every day. He has come that he might rule the towns, lead the settlements*], *and govern those in Nu.'*
Thus, sit at that eastern side, with your sweating ended and your cooling pleasant. You shall follow Ra in his becoming fresh, come forth with him in [*the east, and set from life with him in the west, among the followers of Ra, who elevate the above for the dawn*].
/*PT* spell 603 (P 303)/

The *poiesis* of the pharaoh's origins are from various gods, who offer their carnal contributions to constitute different parts of his body. Here, we observe the use of the theology category as a source for the "production model" of the pharaoh.

Added to this, the King shall have all his body functions re-established in the rituals that were usually rituals of opening, for instance: the mouth had to be open to speak and to eat, the eyes to look and see, the ears to listen and to hear. From an anthropological point of view, the specific type of divinity is here produced with a lot of human references, such as the act of eating. Moreover, the act of re-establishing the the functions of the body invokes the idea that the *poiesis* is not done for the first time: it is more close to a restoration process, perhaps a re-use of flesh and vital essence.

§ 1673a *j.wn.tn n NN jrtj.f wbꜣ.tn n.f šrt.f*
§ 1673b *wp.tn n NN r.f snš.tn n.f msḏrwj.f*
§ 1673c *srd.tn n NN šwtj.f*
§ 1674a *ḏ.tn swꜣ NN ḥr ntr*
§ 1674b *mḥ m sʿḥw tꜣww*
§ 1674c *wnm.n.tn nw gm NN zp ḫr.tn*
§ 1674d *rḏ.tn n NN zp* (*sk sw*) *jj.j*

May you open his eyes for the King, may you break open his nostrils for him, may you split open his mouth for the King, may you unblock his ears for him and grow his plumes for him. May you cause the King to surpass the god, who is filled with the power of the winds. When you have eaten this, the King will find the remainder with you, and you will give the King the remainder, for he has come. /PT spell 602 §1673a-1674d (M 227, N 362)/

Furthermore, the pharaoh, who will revivify, needs to be pure and complete, thus he must purify himself and concurrently Ra purifies him:

§ 710a *wʿb.j w šzp<j> n.j st.j wʿbt jmt pt*
§ 710b *j.mn.<j> j.mn swt.j nfrt*
§ 710c *šzp.<j> n.j st.j wʿbt jmt ḥꜣt wjꜣ rʿ*
§ 711a *jn ḥm jrw-jz*(*?*) *ḫnnjw rʿ*
§ 711b *ntsn ḫn.sn wj*
§ 711c *jn ḥm jrw-jz*(*?*) *pšrjw rʿ ḥꜣ ꜣḫt*
§ 711d *ntsn pšr.sn-n-wj ḥꜣ ꜣḫt*
§ 712a *wp.<j> n.j r.j wbꜣ.<j> n.j šrt.j*
§ 712b *zꜣš.j n.j / snš.n NN msḏrwj.j*
§ 712c *wḏʿ.j mdw wpj.j snnw*
§ 713a *wḏ.j mdw n wr jr.j*
§ 713b *wʿb wj rʿ ḫw.f w m ʿ jrjjt jr.j ḏw*

I will purify myself, I will assume my pure place which is in the sky, I will endure and my perfect places will endure, I assume my pure seat which is in the bow of the Bark of Ra. It is the sailors who row Ra, it is they who will row me, and it is the sailors who convey Ra around the horizon, it is they who will convey me around the horizon. My mouth has been split open for me, my nose has been opened up for me, my ears have been unblocked for me. I will give judgement and I will judge between two contestants, I will give orders to one who is greater than I. Ra purifies me and protects me from what might be evilly done against me. /PT spell 407 (T 284, P 293, M 209, N 354)/

Ra demonstrates his *anthropo-poietical* – causative power purifying the pharaoh, who has an important role in contributing to its own regeneration as well. As a consequence we can call it *auto-poiesis*. Additionally, it looks evident that the *poietical* process is made thanks to different contributors and all play a relevant role. We see a sharing of *anthropo-poietical* power among different actors at the same time: they unify their efforts in order to provide *poiesis* to the pharaoh. Every single being seems to assist and help.

In fact, the King is a being who receives *ka* – the vital essence from every god, but in particular from Atum – the creator, for he is his son and he is Atum himself simultaneously:

§ 1652a *tm ḫprr ḳ3.n.k m ḳ33*
§ 1652b *wbn.n.k m bnbn m ḥwt-bnw m jwnw*
§ 1652c *jšš.n.k m šw tfn.n.k m tfnt*
§ 1653a *d.n.k ꜥwj.k ḥ3.sn m ꜥwj k3 wn k3.k jm.sn*
§ 1653b *tm d.*(*k*) *n.k ꜥwj.k ḥ3 NN*
§ 1653c (*ḥ3 k3t tn ḥ3 mr pn*) *m ꜥwj k3*
§ 1653d *wm k3 n NN jm.f rwḏ n ḏt ḏt*

O Atum-who-is-coming-into-being. When you became high as the mound, you rose up as the benben *in the Mansion of the bird* benu *in Junu, you sneezed Shu, you spat out Tefnut, and you set your arms about them as the arms of* ka*, that your essence might be in them. O Atum, place your arms about the King,* (*about this construction, and about this pyramid*) *as the arms of* ka*, that the King's essence* (ka) *may be in it, enduring for ever and ever.* /PT spell 600 §1652-1653 (M 225, N 359)/

The pharaoh, at least in the Old Kingdom, was perceived as a god, but not just as one of the gods, but as the creator god Atum – all and nothing, life and inertness from before the creation, universe and non-existence. He was called the firstborn son of Atum concurrently:

§ 213a *tm sjꜥ n.k wnjs pn šn n.k sw m ḫnw ꜥwj.k*
§ 213b *z3.k pw n ḏt.k n ḏt*

O Atum, raise this Unis up to you, enclose him within your embrace, for he is your son of your body forever. /PT spell 222 §213 (W 155)/

Moreover, the facts that the King did not die, he did not die a death as common people did, did not die a second – final and destructive – death, strongly confirmed the divine nature of the pharaoh. This aspect makes the *anthropo-poiestical* process unique also because it has no end. Thus, the monarch was able to overcome the state of inertness and assume the form of the creator:

§ 657e *ṯz ṯw NN pw nj mjjt.k/mt.k*

Rise yourself, o King, for you have not died! /*PT* spell 373 § 657e (T 204, M 15, N 62)/

Consequently, as has already been mentioned above, in the final stage of his journey to the sky the pharaoh was the son of the creator and reaching the Hereafter at the same time he was the creator himself. This was his final *anthropo-poiesis,* which indeed ceases to be *anthropo-* and becomes his *poiesis* into the creator god. Once again, we see the ambivalence of the nature of the pharaoh, between human and divine, a cause of the carnal references of his body:

§ 134a *hꜣ wnjs nj šm.n.k js mt.tj šm.n.k ꜥnḫ.t*
§ 134b *ḥms ḥr ḫnd wsjr ꜥbꜣ.k m ꜥ.k wḏ.k mdw n ꜥnḫw*
§ 134c *mks nḥbt.k m ꜥ.k wḏ mdw n štꜣw swt*
§ 135a *ꜥwj.k m tm rmnwj.k m tm ḫt.k m tm sꜣ.k m tm*
§ 135b *pḥ.k m tm rdwj.k m tm ḥr.k m zꜣb*
§ 135c *pšr n.k jꜣwt ḥrw pšr n.k jꜣwt stš*

O Unis, it is not dead but alive that you have gone away.
Sit upon the throne of Osiris!
Your sceptre ꜥbꜣ is in your hand, may you give orders to the living.
mks and your sceptre nḥbt are in your hand, so give orders to
those-whose-seats-are-hidden.
Your arms are those of Atum, your shoulders are those of Atum,
Your belly is that of Atum, your back is that of Atum,
Your hind-parts are those of Atum, your legs are those of Atum,
Your face is that of Jackal.
Let the mounds of Horus serve you, and let the mounds of Seth serve you.
/*PT* spell 213 (W 146)/

The King lived many transformations, which the authors like to call metamorphoses following J. Popielska-Grzybowska's observations.[10] Even grammar constructions in the Egyptian texts are of help, as for example the *m* of predication that was used to identify something with something else.[11] The pharaoh had to be changing his body form and become, for instance, a bird to fly up or a snake to overcome difficulties etc. We see here the reference to the zoology category: not only theology is taken into consideration for the creation of the pharaoh. Every single form – thus every metamorphosis – was to assist him on his way up to the sky.

That the pharaoh was the primaeval being was confirmed by the fact he was born in Heliopolis – treated as the city of the beginning – and moreover had been created before anything else including time and death:

§1041a *ppj* [*pw wꜥ*] *n ḫt tw ꜥꜣt msjjt m bꜣḥ m jwnw*
§ 1041b *j.tmjw jtjw n nswt*
§ 1041c *šd.tj.sn n srw*
§ 1041d *j.tmjw njk j.tmjw ḫb n ḫrw.sn*

Pepi is [*the unique one of*] *that great body that was born formerly in Junu* (*Heliopolis*)*, who are not arrested for the King or taken to officials* (*for judgment*)*, who are not accused, who are not found guilty.* /PT spell 486 § 1039a-1041a (P338, N 548)/

Or as expressed by the Egyptians in other words:

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[10] Popielska-Grzybowska, *O Osiris Nemtiemzaf Merenre*.

[11] On this topic see: A.H. Gardiner, *Egyptian Grammar*, Oxford 1957, pp. 40–41 § 38; 46 § 44, 2; 92–94 § 116–117; 125 § 162, 6; 151, § 200, 8; E. Edel, *Altägyptische Grammatik*, vol. 2, AnOr34, 39, Rome 1964, pp. 389, § 758h; H. Grapow, *Die bildlichen Ausdrücke des Aegyptischen. Vom Denken und Dichten einer altorientalischen Sprache*, Leipzig 1924, pp. 3, 73, 179; T. Shehab el-Din, Note on the so-called m of predication, *Discussions in Egyptology* 42 (1998), pp. 15-24F; D. Scalf, Statements of Identity and the m of Predication, *Lingua Aegyptia* 16 (2008), pp. 135-151; J. Popielska-Grzybowska, Religious Reality Creation through Language in the Old Kingdom Religious Texts, [in:] M. Bárta, F. Coppens, J. Krejčí (eds), *Abusir and Saqqara in the Year 2010*, Prague 2011, p. 688 and Eadem, *O Osiris Nemtiemzaf Merenre*.

§1660a *jꜣ] psḏt ꜥꜣt jmt jwnw rḏ.ṯn rwḏ mrj rꜥ*
§ 1660b [*ḏ.ṯn rwḏ mr pn n mrj rꜥ kꜣt.f tn n*] *ḏt* [*ḏt*
§ 1660c *mr rwḏ rn n tm ḫntj*] *psḏt ꜥꜣt*

O], *Big Ennead in Junu* (*Heliopolis*)! *May you make Meryre* [*firm, may you make this pyramid firm for*] [*ever and ever as the name of Atum, foremost of*] *the Big Ennead,* [*is*]. /*PT* spell 601 (P 582)/

The above-mentioned – in the Egyptian writing – firmness provides endurance and everlastingness.[12] All in all, the monarch as god could not experience a human death. His lot was continuous and eternal life. This is the main aspect that makes his *poiesis* different from this of all the others: he cannot die:

§ 604a *wḏ.n nw ttj n tm*
§ 604b *wḏ.n pgꜣ ttj n šw*
§ 604c *ḏ.(f) j.wn.tj ꜥꜣwj pt jpf n ttj ḫr rmṯ*
§ 604d *nj rn.sn js*
§ 604e *nḏr n.k ttj ḫr ꜥ.f šd n.k ttj jr pt*
§ 604f *jm.f mt jr tꜣ mm rmṯ*

Nu has commended Teti to Atum, This-who-is-open-armed has commended Teti to Shu, that he might have opened yonder door of the sky to Teti, now among unidentified people, (*saying*): '*Take Teti by his arm, take Teti to the sky, that he may not die on Earth among people.*' /PT spell 361 (T 183)/

As it has been mentioned before, the pharaoh was made alive and living by many creatures and gods. He – being a primaeval one coming from the pre-waters Nu – was sent by Nu to the creator who subsequently directed him to Shu – his divine firstborn son. Perhaps it was an incentive given by Nu in the process of creation.[13] However important all transformations were, the final and decisive ones were linked to beings related to Atum:

§ 1872a *hꜣ šw wsjr pw ppj rḏ.n.k sḏb.kf ꜥnḫ.f*
§ 1872b *ꜥnḫ.k ꜥnḫ.f ṯwt nb tꜣ r ḏr.f*

Ho, Shu! This is Osiris Pepi, whom you have made revive and live. You live, and he lives. You are the lord of the entire world. /PT spell 660 § 1872a-b (P 209, N 400)/

Yet, all that was done in favour of the King to prepare and equip him well for his heavenly existence was concluded by his identification with the creator, who gave him his form and his *ka*:

§ 1465a *sḏm gbb rpꜥt nṯrw tm ꜥpr sw m jrw.f*

Hear, Geb, member of the elite of the gods! *Atum, equip him with his form*! /*PT* spell 570B (P 510)/

[12] J. Popielska-Grzybowska, Nu, continuity and everlastingness in the Pyramid Texts (hereinafter referred to as: Nu), [in:] M. Tomorad, J. Popielska-Grzybowska (eds), *Proceedings of the Seventh European Conference of Egyptologists. Egypt 2015: Perspectives of Research*, Oxford 2017, pp. 17-29.

[13] See: Popielska-Grzybowska, Nu, pp. 19, 26.

As a consequence, the pharaoh was **complete of** every god in a physical sense, which had religious and spiritual implications. Every part of his body was identified with an appropriate body part of the god:

§ 147b *ṯn kw jn.sn m rn.k n nṯr ḫpr.k j.tm.t* (*m*) *nṯr nb*
§ 148a *tp.k m ḥrw dȝt j.ḫm-sk*
§ 148b *mḫnt.k m ḫntj-jrtj j.ḫm-sk*
§ 148c *msḏrwj.k zȝtj tm j.ḫm-sk jrtj.k zȝtj tm j.ḫm-sk*
§ 148d *fnḏ.k m zȝb j.ḫm-sk jbḥw.k spdw j.ḫm-sk*
§ 149a *ʿwj.k ḥp dwȝ-mwt.f dbḥ.k pr.k r pt prr.k*
§ 149b *rdwj.k jmst ḳbḥ-snw.f dbḥ.k hȝ.k jr nwt hȝȝ.k*
§ 149c *ʿwt.k zȝtj tm j.ḫm-sk*
§ 149d *nj sk.k nj sk kȝ.k ṯwt kȝ*

You are distinguished – say they, in your name of god become complete of[14] *every god*
Your head is that of Horus of the Duat, O Imperishable!
Your face is that of Khenti-irti, O Imperishable!
Your ears are those of the Twins of Atum, O Imperishable!
Your eyes are those of the Twins of Atum, O Imperishable!
Your nose is that of the Jackal, O Imperishable!
Your teeth are those of Sopdu, O Imperishable!
Your arms are those of Hep and Duamutef,
which you need to ascend to the sky and you shall ascend
Your legs are Imsetj and Kebehsenuf,
which you need to descend to the lower sky and you shall descend.
All your members are the Twins of Atum, O Imperishable!
You shall not perish and your ka shall not perish – you are ka. /*PT* spell 215/

Finally, the pharaoh becomes and is the essence of every god. His *anthropo-poiesis* is completed thanks to their support. *Ka* essence which is a realisation of the creator-*tm* the complete one – provides completeness. It is the finalisation of the *anthropo-poiesis*:

§ 1609a *wsjr nmtjj m zȝf mr n rʿ ṯwt kȝ n nṯrw nb*

O Osiris Nemtiemzaf Merenre, you are the essence ka *of every god*!
/*PT* spell 589 § 1609a (M 32A)/

Conclusion

The perception of the pharaoh and his body as a means of change, namely the metamorphoses, the transfer of divinity in ancient Egypt was very different than in other cultures. Ancient Egyptian culture was highly sensory,[15] hence it paid a lot of attention to the completeness of the body. The body of the pharaoh was a physical symbol of assuming this completeness. Ethnography reports very few examples of *anthropo-poiesis* which are delimitated in a single moment; usually we see that they are thought of as a process of

[14] J. Popielska-Grzybowska, Atum in the Pyramid Texts, [in:] J. Popielska-Grzybowska (ed.), *Proceedings of the First Central European Conference of Young Egyptologists, Egypt 1999*: *Perspectives of Research*, *Warsaw 7–9 June 1999*, Światowit Supplement Series E: Egyptology, vol. I, WES, vol. III, Warsaw 2001, pp. 120-124.

[15] J. Popielska-Grzybowska, Senses in ancient Egyptian rebirth of the deceased pharaoh and performative aspects of Egyptian religion. The Pyramid Texts' example, [in:] C. Saraiva, J. Rousseau (eds), *Making Sense of Religion Performance, Art and Experience*, Lisbon, forthcoming.

creations speeded-out over a lifetime. Instead, the pharaoh's poiesis is thus accomplished. Furthermore, the body of the pharaoh was a manifestation of completeness in every sense. A real challenge to biological incompleteness.

§ 1076g *ppj js pj ṯmj sn n ṯjmw*
§ *1076h *ḏḥwtj m zꜣ.j tm.kj tm.kj*

For Pepi is chemi*, the brother of* chimu. *Thoth is my son. I am complete, I am complete.* /*PT* spell 502L (P 410)/

However, this very body being a symbol of reaching the goal in the sky, it was treated in a very verbatim way and was believed to be a representative of the process of creation and re-creation of every being, on Earth as also in the Hereafter. This is the main reason why we call it *anthropo-poiesis*, referring clearly to the human nature of the pharaoh, and not only about his divine essence: both elements are considered as essential in his *poiesis*.

In conclusion, all fragments describing in this or another way the completeness of the body of the pharaoh were always adducing or at least alluding to Atum the creator. Consequently, assuming different shapes and forms, namely all stages of identification of the pharaoh with different beings, various gods and finally the creator god Atum, led to the biological and mental completeness of the King. This was overcoming the physical, typical of the human world death, and consequently welcoming continuous everlastingness.[16]

[16] Popielska-Grzybowska, Nu, pp. 17-29.